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FOREWORD

I have the honour of presenting the 27th edition of "Finger Prints in India," the NCRB's Central Finger Print Bureau's annual report covering the year 2023. Published by the Bureau since 1997, this book provides an overview of the efforts and innovative success stories in the field of Fingerprint Science undertaken by the Central and State/UT Finger Print Bureaux (SFPBx).

Details of the significant cases that the State Finger Print Bureaux (SFPBx) and Central Finger Print Bureau (CFPB) have resolved are included in this year's publication. It also contains information on the transactional operations carried out by the State FPBx, such as expert visits to crime scenes, the lifting of chance prints, the enrolment of convicts' fingerprints, the processing of arrestees' slips to determine their criminal history, the examination of document cases, the provision of expert opinions, etc. The fingerprint statistics included in this article will aid in the development of a better knowledge of the fingerprint domain for Law Enforcement Agencies, academics, scholars, researchers and others and also help in planning for future.

The NCRB/MHA flagship project, the National Automated Fingerprints Identification System (NAFIS) Project, is currently operating nationwide and has created a national Searchable Digital Database of criminal fingerprints that is accessible from all parts of the country.

The National Crime Records Bureau is mandated to collect, store, process, share and destroy records of measurements of arrested and convicted individuals under the Criminal Procedure (Identification) Act, 2022. CrP (I) System will add more modalities, including Face, Iris and DNA in national digital searchable Database.

The current issue of this yearly book, which aims to maximize the evidential value of fingerprints in the criminal justice system, will undoubtedly make an empirical and analytical addition to the subject. I wish to express my gratitude to each and every State/UT Finger Print Bureau for helping the Bureau and making sure the report was published on time. I also wish to express my gratitude to the CFPB officials for their very hard work in producing this book.

5th December, 2024

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Alok Ranjan', with a horizontal line drawn underneath it.

(Alok Ranjan)